

UNIT 4 / Build your sentences

Mission: build a sentence

Your goal: Keep the verb in second position when starting with time or place.

01 Learn the idea

The verb is second in a normal statement, but the first element can contain more than one word. Ich lerne heute Deutsch and Heute lerne ich Deutsch are both possible. When heute comes first, the subject moves after the verb. Second position means the second element, not always the second written word.

Use a short time phrase such as am Abend to vary your sentences: Am Abend lerne ich Deutsch. Keep a yes/no question separate: Lernst du heute? It begins with the verb. Read your sentence aloud, identify the conjugated verb and check the element before it. This habit makes longer sentences easier later.

Words and phrases

German	English
Heute lerne ich Deutsch.	Today I am learning German.
Am Abend spiele ich.	In the evening I play.
Hier wohnt Mia.	Mia lives here.
Morgen komme ich.	I am coming tomorrow.
Jetzt machen wir eine Pause.	Now we are taking a break.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Ben

Was machst du heute?

What are you doing today?

Mia

Heute lerne ich Deutsch. Am Abend spiele ich Fußball.

Today I study German. In the evening I play football.

Ben

Morgen lerne ich auch.

Tomorrow I study too.

Your real-life mission

Rewrite Ich lerne heute Deutsch starting with Heute. Then write two new statements starting with Morgen and Am Abend, and one yes/no question.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Heute lerne ich Deutsch.” mean?

- A. In the evening I play.
- B. Today I am learning German.
- C. Mia lives here.

2. What does “Am Abend spiele ich.” mean?

- A. Mia lives here.
- B. I am coming tomorrow.
- C. In the evening I play.

3. What does “Hier wohnt Mia.” mean?

- A. Mia lives here.
- B. I am coming tomorrow.
- C. Now we are taking a break.

4. Choose the standard statement.

- A. Heute ich lerne Deutsch.
- B. Heute lerne ich Deutsch.
- C. Heute Deutsch ich lerne.

5. What does Mia do in the evening?

- A. Plays football
- B. Studies English
- C. Buys a book

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. B - Today I am learning German.

“Heute lerne ich Deutsch.” means “Today I am learning German.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. C - In the evening I play.

“Am Abend spiele ich.” means “In the evening I play.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. A - Mia lives here.

“Hier wohnt Mia.” means “Mia lives here.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - Heute lerne ich Deutsch.

After the first element Heute, the conjugated verb lerne comes second.

5. A - Plays football

Mia says Am Abend spiele ich Fußball.

One possible mission response

Heute lerne ich Deutsch. Morgen komme ich. Am Abend spiele ich Fußball. Lernst du heute?

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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